

Experience with AI usage in Data Analysis 3
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At the beginning of Data Analysis 3 course, I was aware we were expected to make sure of AI, but I expected AI use to be much more restricted than it was. I assumed the use would come with more warnings or only allowed in very limited situations. Instead, I was surprised by how openly we were encouraged to use it, as long as we took responsibility and did not submit purely AI-generated work. This honestly not only allowed me to realise the potential of AI, but also understand the importance of self-regulation in this new age of AI.

For studying and exam preparation, it was most helpful as a revision tool. I used it to explain concepts first in short and simple language and then more in-depth. If I was confused about something like logit vs LPM, or how ROC and AUC connected, I would ask for clarification and then follow up with more detailed questions. I also asked ChatGPT to create mock MCQs and short questions to test myself, and then checked my answers to understand where I made mistakes. What helped most was being able to ask very vague questions and clear my confusions with small examples or practical scenarios that made abstract ideas simpler to grasp.

For assignments, I used it more as a support tool, almost like an assistant who was doing just the most boring tasks of an interesting project. I designed my own structure, decided which models to use, and wrote the logic and interpretation myself. When coding parts, I asked for help drafting or cleaning up specific parts, especially repetitive sections, but I always specified what I wanted and checked the output carefully, also to make sure my brain was actually being utilised, to put simply.

For me, the main risk was that even when codes or explanations that were AI-generated looked very neat, it did miss a lot of instructions here and there, or didn't connect with the previous section or overall context of my work. If I did not slow down and verify things myself, it was easy to miss small errors. I have been a bit more cautious and try to use AI outputs as a support material rather than final answers.

Overall, it helped most when I was stuck or unsure how to start, because it made the learning process more interactive. In my opinion, the downside of this oversimplified way of learning and applying takes 'struggling' completely out of the equation, and I feel that a bit of struggle is usually necessary to really and truly learn new skills on a deeper level.

However, despite the pros and cons, AI is our current reality, and it will only get more advanced. I wouldn't make the AI policy any more restrictive going forward. Instead, I think integration (which is how we're doing it in this program) is the right way to go, since institutional regulations are unlikely to prevent use. I would maybe emphasize a bit more on reflection and responsibility of the user. The important skill is not avoiding AI, but rather to learn how to use it critically and independently, with a good amount of self-regulation.